

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

REAL0.08

UTILI0.22

ENERG0.50

COMM.0.57

CONS.0.70

FINAN1.05

INDUS1.19

HEALT1.24

CONS.1.75

TECHN7.08

MATER85.44

1

MU

BUY

\$971.66

+2.30%

8/10

Micron is the memory backbone of the AI buildout — HBM (high-bandwidth

2

NVDA

BUY

\$225.16

-0.06%

8/10

The picks-and-shovels play for a multi-trillion dollar AI infrastru

3

GOOGL

BUY

\$345.90

-0.13%

8/10

Gemini is quietly winning the consumer AI race while Search cash cow f

Big options bets on XOM (Energy) — 37.9x normal volume, P/C 0.02, largest: CALL \$149 (605.5x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP	FED & ECONOMY TODAY	SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?
No major earnings this week	No major events today	No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Big money is piling into the classic defensive-plus-yield playbook: Real Estate, Utilities, and Energy are all seeing 4x normal call volume, which tells me institutions are positioning for lower rates ahead (which juices REITs and utilities) while simultaneously betting energy stays firm — likely tied to expectations that the administration keeps leaning on domestic production, LNG export approvals, and Middle East risk premium staying elevated.

On the flip side, someone is aggressively hedging or outright shorting Technology (a stunning 7-to-1 put/call ratio) and Materials is off the charts bearish at 85-to-1 — that Materials print screams tariff retaliation fears and a China demand scare, while the tech hedging suggests the smart money thinks the AI trade is priced for perfection right as antitrust noise, export controls, and a potential capex digestion phase loom.

The Consumer Discretionary bearishness alongside widening credit spreads and heavy put buying in both HYG and LQD is the tell most people are missing — that combination historically front-runs a growth scare where the consumer cracks and companies have a harder time refinancing debt, usually 4-8 weeks before it shows up in headlines.

The contradiction worth flagging: indexes near highs are being carried by a handful of mega-cap tech names that options desks are actively betting against, meaning the "market" looks fine while the internals are quietly rotating into recession-resistant sectors.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.91/100
Leidos combines a rare defense-tech profile with a compelling 1.0			
2.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	8.91/100
SMCI is the leading AI server OEM leveraging NVIDIA GPU allocatio			
3.	MDB	MongoDB, Inc.	8.46/100
MongoDB's Atlas platform is emerging as the de facto vector datab			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 17–18	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy \$305.93 ▲ 0.22% 12M Price Target \$340.00 52-Week Range \$223.78 – \$344.57 Market Cap \$4.46T

AAPL: iPhone Redesign On Track, Tariff Cloud Lingers

WHAT HAPPENED

- Barely moved (+0.22%) — the story overnight is that Apple's big iPhone redesign is confirmed still on track. That matters because a real redesign (first major one in years) is what drives an upgrade "super-cycle" — meaning millions of people who've been holding old phones finally trade up, juicing revenue.
- Meanwhile Google's Gemini AI hit 1 billion users. That's the shadow hanging over Apple — the market is worried Apple is losing the AI race while everyone else sprints ahead.

WHY IT MATTERS

The stock is sitting at 68% of its 52-week range and going nowhere fast this week — that tells me the market is in "show me" mode ahead of the September iPhone launch. Options flow is loudly bullish (call buyers outnumbering put buyers 2-to-1, with unusual call activity right at the current price) — smart money is positioning for a pop, likely tied to the iPhone reveal. But here's the tension: even if the iPhone redesign is a hit, Apple's AI story is weak, and the market is now paying premium multiples for AI winners (Google, Nvidia) while Apple gets a "hardware company" discount. The setup: a good product cycle keeps the stock grinding higher, but re-rating to \$360+ probably requires Apple to show a credible AI answer.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The single biggest political variable for Apple is China tariffs — Apple still makes the majority of iPhones in China, and any tariff escalation flows straight through to margins or forces price hikes that hurt demand. The Trump administration's ongoing tariff pressure has pushed Apple to accelerate India manufacturing, but that shift takes years, not quarters. Also watch antitrust: the DOJ's App Store case is still grinding forward, and any forced changes to Apple's 30% App Store tax would hit Services revenue — which is the highest-margin, fastest-growing part of the business.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~41x forward earnings, you're paying \$41 for every \$1 of profit Apple makes next year — that's expensive for a company growing revenue in the mid-single digits. It's justified only if you believe (a) the iPhone redesign triggers a real upgrade wave, and (b) Services keeps compounding at 12%+. Compared to Google trading cheaper with better AI momentum, Apple looks fully priced — you're paying for the brand fortress and \$100B+ in annual cash generation, not for growth.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$305.93
12M Price Target	\$340.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.1%
Market Cap	\$4.46T
FY2026E Revenue	\$435M
FY2027E Revenue	\$470M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.45
FY2027E EPS	\$8.30
Fwd P/E	41.1x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$325.00	\$310.00	\$290.00
6 Months	\$360.00	\$325.00	\$275.00
1 Year	\$385.00	\$340.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$450.00	\$375.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$460.00	\$230.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy is on fire (+7.7% in 5 days) — likely geopolitical/supply driven. Utilities also bid up as a defensive AI-power play (data centers need electricity).

COOLING OFF: Tech isn't in the top movers today, which is telling — the AI trade is taking a breather and money is rotating to cyclical and defensives.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving OUT of mega-cap tech and INTO energy and rate-sensitive names. That's a headwind for Apple in the short term — when the "Magnificent 7" trade cools, Apple gets sold as a source of funds.

RELATED PLAY: If you want the iPhone redesign trade without paying Apple's premium, look at the suppliers — Qualcomm (modems), Skyworks, and the memory names (Sandisk got a mention today) all benefit from an iPhone upgrade cycle.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GOOGL (Alphabet): Gemini hitting 1B users is a genuine AI consumer win — they're monetizing AI in ways Apple isn't.
- INTC (Intel): \$23B capital raise for foundry business — a bet that US-based chip manufacturing has policy tailwinds (CHIPS Act money still flowing).

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is LAGGING the AI winners and lagging the energy/cyclical rotation. It's stuck in the middle — not cheap enough to be a value play, not growing fast enough to be a growth play. The stock needs its own catalyst (the iPhone reveal) to break out of this range.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Apple is a "sleep well at night" core holding, not a table-pounding buy here. The business is a fortress but the stock is priced like it.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% as a core holding. This isn't a trade, it's a long-term compounder — but I wouldn't overweight it at 41x earnings.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$295 or below. Any tariff scare or broad market selloff that gets it near \$280 is a gift.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The near-term catalyst is the September iPhone reveal; the medium-term catalyst is proving out an AI strategy.

WHEN TO BAIL: If iPhone units disappoint two quarters in a row, or if the DOJ forces structural App Store changes, or if China tariffs jump another 10%+ — trim aggressively.

HEDGING: Own a smaller position in Google alongside it — that way if the AI narrative keeps punishing Apple, you're on both sides of the trade. Or buy cheap out-of-the-money puts around earnings for insurance.

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$174.04 ▼ 2.78%	12M Price Target \$185.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$418.23B
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PLTR: Priced for Perfection, Policy Still a Tailwind

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock dipped 2.78% on lower volume — the Motley Fool piece flagging "74x sales" (meaning investors are paying \$74 for every \$1 of revenue PLTR generates) is doing exactly what you'd expect: making people ask if the party's gone too far. That's not a fundamental problem, that's a gravity problem.
- Peter Thiel dropping \$118M into a "surging big tech stock" is the counterweight — insider-adjacent smart money still leaning in, and the options market agrees (unusual call buying at \$118-136 strikes signals bullish positioning for September).

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension: PLTR is riding two of the biggest political tailwinds in the market — the ongoing DoD AI modernization push and the federal government's aggressive shift toward commercial AI vendors — but the stock has priced in essentially perfect execution for the next 3-5 years. When something trades at 74x sales, it's not investing anymore, it's a bet that growth stays 40%+ for years. The dip today probably means the market is starting to distinguish between "great company" and "great stock at this price" — those aren't the same thing. Watch for continued rotation OUT of PLTR into cheaper "Rule of 40" software names (that Motley Fool headline about a comparable Rule of 40 stock at cheaper valuation is a tell that institutional narratives are shifting).

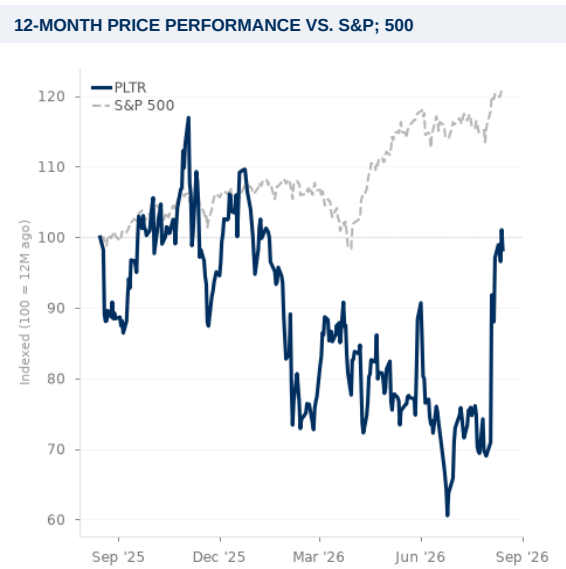
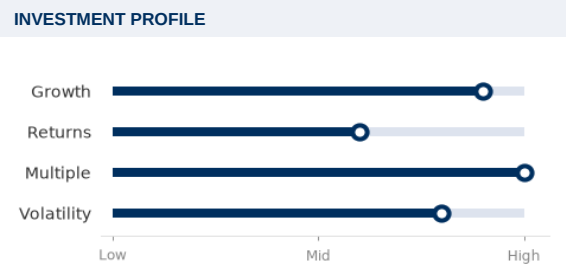
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The FY2026 defense budget continues to prioritize software-defined warfare and AI-enabled command systems — PLTR's Maven Smart System is arguably the single biggest beneficiary of this shift, and the recent \$10B ceiling expansion on their Army contract is proof. Also watch the ongoing federal AI procurement reforms: the administration's push to accelerate commercial AI adoption across civilian agencies (Treasury, HHS, VA) is a direct pipeline expansion for PLTR's Foundry platform. The risk on the horizon: any bipartisan AI safety/liability legislation that adds compliance friction for government AI deployments — PLTR would likely still win but the sales cycles could lengthen.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$174 and ~\$418B market cap, you're paying about 74x forward sales — for context, even Nvidia at peak hype traded around 30x sales, and most premium software names top out at 15-20x. The justification requires PLTR to compound revenue at 40%+ for 5 straight years AND expand margins meaningfully — possible, but there's no margin for error. Translation: even if the business does great, the stock can still go down if growth "only" hits 30%.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$174.04
12M Price Target	\$185.00
Upside / (Downside)	+6.3%
Market Cap	\$418.23B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.62
FY2027E EPS	\$0.88
Fwd P/E	280.7x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$195.00	\$178.00	\$155.00
6 Months	\$220.00	\$185.00	\$140.00
1 Year	\$250.00	\$195.00	\$125.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$220.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$300.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$450.00	\$75.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.67% 5D) is on fire — likely tied to geopolitical tension and continued grid/data-center power demand narrative. Utilities are also creeping up, which historically means defensive rotation is starting.

COOLING OFF: Materials went negative on the week, and tech/software isn't in the top movers — that's a subtle sign the "everything AI" trade is losing breadth.

ROTATION WATCH: Money quietly rotating from high-multiple software into energy and utilities — that's a "late-cycle AI trade" tell. The AI infrastructure story (power, cooling, grid) is beating the AI application story (PLTR).

RELATED PLAY: If you like the PLTR thesis but hate the valuation, look at defense primes with AI exposure (LMT, RTX) or the data-center power beneficiaries (VST, CEG) — same tailwind, way cheaper multiples.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- VST (Vistra): AI power demand thesis, cheaper multiple, direct beneficiary of same federal spending trends
- ANET (Arista Networks): AI networking backbone, growing 25%+ at fraction of PLTR's multiple

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is still leading the software/AI cohort YTD, but the -2.78% today with the sector broadly flat suggests it's starting to lag on valuation gravity, not fundamentals. Historically when a name trades this rich, the stock consolidates for 6-12 months while earnings catch up to the price — that's the most likely scenario here.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Love the business, respect the moat, terrified of the entry price. Cautiously constructive but not pounding the table here.

POSITION SIZE: 2-3% max — the volatility is real (52-week range is \$106-\$207, that's a 95% swing) so size for the vol, not just the thesis

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$150-160 for a real add. Chasing \$174 after a run from \$106 is buying enthusiasm, not value

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is Q3/Q4 earnings and the FY27 defense budget process

WHEN TO BAIL: Revenue growth drops below 25% YoY, US commercial growth decelerates two quarters in a row, or Karp announces departure — any of those and I'm cutting

HEDGING: If you're up big on PLTR, consider selling covered calls against your position to harvest some of that insane implied volatility (options premiums are elevated) — that pays you to wait while you hold the stock

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy	\$262.65 ▼ 0.94%	12M Price Target \$310.00	52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$287.20	Market Cap \$2.83T
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AMZN: Five-Day Slide as Consumer Worries Meet AI Spending Fears

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN is down five straight days — from \$278 to \$262 — and today's Goldman note about consumer spending fading as tax refunds run out is the fresh excuse. Translation: Wall Street is starting to worry the US shopper is tapped out heading into back-to-school and holiday, which hits Amazon's retail engine directly.
- The 24/7 Wall St. piece framing Amazon as a "squeezed hyperscaler" with a cash flow problem is the other overhang. "Hyperscaler" just means the giant cloud companies (AWS, Azure, Google Cloud) — and the market is increasingly nervous they're spending tens of billions on AI data centers without proof the revenue justifies it.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension: the options market is loudly bullish (put/call ratio of 0.58, with big call buying at \$230–\$240 strikes — meaning traders are betting the stock stays well above those levels), but the tape is telling you the opposite short-term. That gap usually resolves one of two ways — either the stock finds a floor here and rips on the next positive AWS data point, or we get one more flush toward \$250 that scares out weak hands. The Bezos sell of \$346M on Aug 3 near the highs looks prescient in hindsight but is programmatic (10b5-1 plan), so don't read too much into it. Bigger picture: with the stock at 73% of its 52-week range and consumer worries stacking up, this is starting to look like a "buy the fear" setup rather than a "chase the breakout" one — but you want to see the bleeding stop first.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two political threads matter right now: (1) tariff policy on Chinese goods remains the sword hanging over Amazon's third-party seller marketplace — roughly half of GMV comes from sellers who source heavily from China, so any escalation squeezes margins or forces price hikes that hurt volumes. (2) The FTC's antitrust case against Amazon is still grinding through the courts, and any adverse ruling on Prime bundling or third-party seller practices would be a real structural hit. On the tailwind side, federal AI infrastructure spending and defense cloud contracts (JWCC) continue to favor AWS — that's a slow-burn positive that doesn't show up in any single quarter but compounds.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$262.65
12M Price Target	\$310.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.0%
Market Cap	\$2.83T
FY2026E Revenue	\$715M
FY2027E Revenue	\$790M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	38.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$285.00	\$268.00	\$250.00
6 Months	\$310.00	\$285.00	\$240.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$310.00	\$230.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$355.00	\$245.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$450.00	\$275.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.7% over 5 days) is ripping — likely a mix of oil supply concerns and the rotation out of crowded growth/AI names. Utilities catching a bid too, which is classic defensive rotation when people get nervous about the consumer.

COOLING OFF: Mega-cap tech and consumer discretionary — Amazon sits at the crossroads of both, which is why it's getting hit from two sides this week.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly moving from "AI winners" into energy, defensives, and value. That's a warning sign that positioning in names like AMZN is getting reassessed — not panic, but a real rotation.

RELATED PLAY: If the AI capex fears prove overblown, the picks-and-shovels names (data center REITs like EQIX, DLR, and power infrastructure plays) benefit alongside AMZN — arguably with less consumer risk baked in.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- XOM/CVX (Energy majors): riding the sector's +7.7% five-day rip on supply tightness and defensive rotation.
- Utilities broadly: the AI power-demand story keeps giving them a bid even in risk-off tape.

AMZN CONTEXT: Amazon is lagging the tape hard this week — that's not company-specific, it's the "expensive hyperscaler with consumer exposure" trade unwinding. The lag is actually informative: if AMZN can stop going down while energy keeps ripping, that's your signal the rotation is exhausting itself.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — high-quality business at a reasonable price getting sold for macro reasons, not company reasons. That's usually a good setup, but I'm not pounding the table until the slide stops.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% — core holding size. Big enough to matter, small enough that a 15% drawdown doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: Start scaling in here at \$262, add meaningfully at \$250, back up the truck sub-\$245 if we get there on macro fear.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst you're waiting for: an AWS quarter that shows AI revenue is finally showing up in the numbers, not just capex.

WHEN TO BAIL: AWS growth decelerating two quarters in a row below 15%, or retail operating margin compressing meaningfully — those are the real signals the story is broken.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is just keeping some cash on the sidelines to average down. If you want portfolio protection, buying a put on the QQQ (Nasdaq ETF) covers you cheaper than hedging AMZN directly.

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$140.00 ▼ 0.91%	12M Price Target \$155.00	52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.84T
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SPCX: Space ETF Consolidates as SpaceX Halo Grows

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX slipped less than 1% but the real story is the SpaceX news avalanche — Harvard's endowment just disclosed a \$2.2B stake, and Nvidia, Alphabet, and Peter Thiel were revealed as top shareholders. Since SpaceX is a private company and SPCX is one of the few public ways to get space exposure, this "SpaceX halo" tends to pull the whole ETF up — but today the ETF is flat-to-down, which suggests the excitement is being priced into SpaceX's private valuation, not the public names in this fund.
- Morgan Stanley says SpaceX could more than double, and Cathie Wood is publicly bullish — these are secondary tailwinds for SPCX because they legitimize the whole sector, but again, retail money is going to want SpaceX directly, not a proxy.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension with SPCX: it's an ETF (basket of space stocks like Rocket Lab, Iridium, Planet Labs, etc.) so it moves on the underlying holdings, not on SpaceX itself — but the whole space narrative right now is dominated by SpaceX being private. That's actually a problem: when everyone piles into "space as a theme," they realize they can't buy SpaceX directly and either accept SPCX as a proxy OR they buy Rocket Lab (RKLB) individually, which is why the ETF can lag the excitement. Longer term though, the Trump administration's Space Force expansion, the Golden Dome missile defense push, and NASA's Artemis contracting are directly funneling money to the exact companies in this fund. The setup: near-term choppy, medium-term tailwinds are real if defense/space spending holds.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

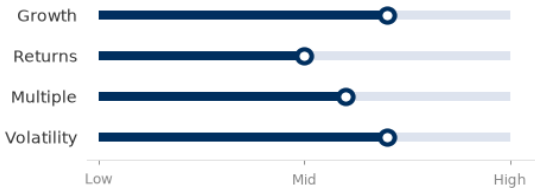
The big one to watch is the FY2027 defense authorization — the Golden Dome missile defense system (Trump's Iron-Dome-for-America project) is projected at \$175B over the decade and space-based sensors are a core piece, which directly benefits satellite operators in SPCX. Also watch the FAA's commercial launch licensing reform — the administration has been pushing to streamline approvals, which is a direct tailwind for Rocket Lab and other launch names in the ETF. Headwind risk: if the debt ceiling fight this fall forces discretionary spending cuts, NASA and unclassified space budgets are soft targets.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$140.00
12M Price Target	\$155.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.7%
Market Cap	\$1.84T
FY2026E Revenue	—
FY2027E Revenue	—
FY2026E EPS	N/M
FY2027E EPS	N/M
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$152.00	\$143.00	\$130.00
6 Months	\$175.00	\$155.00	\$125.00
1 Year	\$200.00	\$165.00	\$115.00
2 Years	\$240.00	\$185.00	\$105.00
5 Years	\$350.00	\$250.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$600.00	\$400.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.7% in 5 days) is ripping on geopolitical/supply concerns, and Industrials are grinding higher — defense primes inside industrials are quietly getting bid on Golden Dome and Space Force budget news.

COOLING OFF: Materials are soft, and pure-play growth/tech (not shown but implied by rotation) is taking a breather as money moves to hard-asset and defense themes.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating into "national security" themes — defense, energy security, and space — which is a direct tailwind for SPCX's underlying holdings even if the ETF itself hasn't caught the bid yet.

RELATED PLAY: If you want more concentrated exposure, RKLB (Rocket Lab) and ITA (defense ETF) are cleaner ways to play the same policy tailwind. Data center REITs also benefit from satellite-to-ground infrastructure buildout.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Winning on Neutron rocket progress and Space Force contract wins — the purest launch play.
- LMT (Lockheed Martin): Not in SPCX but benefiting from the same Golden Dome tailwind — defense primes are the "picks and shovels" of the space buildout.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging its individual big holdings, which tells me the ETF wrapper is being ignored in favor of concentrated single-name bets. That's actually a setup — if the sector keeps running, laggard ETFs tend to catch up as generalist investors seek diversified exposure.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — solid thematic tailwinds but the ETF structure means you miss the SpaceX upside directly, which is where all the retail energy is.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% — enough to matter if the space theme runs, small enough that a Starlink IPO announcement doesn't wreck your portfolio.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for pullbacks to \$130-135 (near recent support) rather than chasing here at \$140. If it breaks \$125, that's a real "back up the truck" level.

TIME HORIZON: 12-36 months — you're waiting for defense budgets to fund through, launch cadence to accelerate, and satellite revenue to compound.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Congress cuts space/defense discretionary in the fall budget fight, or if SpaceX/Starlink formally announces an IPO, reassess immediately — both change the setup.

HEDGING: Easiest hedge is to pair this with a broad defense ETF like ITA — if space specifically stumbles but defense holds, you're partly protected. Or just size smaller and hold cash.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Hold	\$95.56 ▼ 3.83%	12M Price Target \$105.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$85.92B
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HOOD: Crypto Chill Meets White House Crypto Summit Hope

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock dropped ~3.8% Friday after a monster Thursday (+4.7%) — classic profit-taking, but the real driver was Bitcoin slipping below \$63K and the SEC pumping the brakes on tokenization rules. HOOD trades like a leveraged crypto play now, so when Bitcoin sneezes, HOOD catches a cold.
- Two offsetting narratives: bullish → Trump is meeting crypto + prediction markets execs (HOOD is squarely in both buckets), and they just launched a Y Combinator–focused venture fund pushing deeper into private markets. Bearish → options flow shows big money buying downside protection (put/call 0.78, unusual puts at \$93/\$98/\$99 strikes).

WHY IT MATTERS

The unusual put buying at strikes right around current price (\$93-\$99) tells me institutions are hedging into next month — they're not necessarily bearish long-term, but they see event risk (Trump meeting outcome, SEC tokenization decision, next crypto leg). The Y Combinator venture fund is a bigger deal than the market gave it credit for: HOOD is quietly building a full-stack retail platform (stocks + crypto + prediction markets + private companies) — this is the "Amazon of retail finance" pivot. But here's the tension: the stock is priced like that transformation is guaranteed, when in reality it depends heavily on the SEC actually delivering a tokenization framework and Congress not gumming up the works. Near-term, HOOD is basically a Bitcoin proxy with extra features — position accordingly. ===IMPLICATIONS===

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

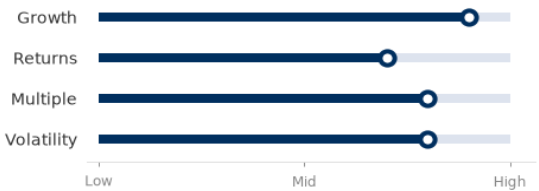
Three live wires: (1) The CLARITY Act / crypto market structure bill — if it passes the Senate this fall, it hands HOOD a regulated path to expand crypto revenue (roughly 35-40% of transaction revenue). (2) The SEC's tokenization rulemaking just stalled, per today's Motley Fool piece — this is the framework that would let HOOD tokenize stocks and private company shares (huge TAM expansion). (3) Prediction markets regulation — the CFTC under Trump is friendlier, and HOOD's Kalshi-style event contracts business could scale fast if federal election contracts get greenlit. Net-net: the regulatory environment is the friendliest it's been in a decade for HOOD, but "friendly" isn't "done" — delays hurt because valuation already prices in wins.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$95.56
12M Price Target	\$105.00
Upside / (Downside)	+9.9%
Market Cap	\$85.92B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,250M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,300M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.45
Fwd P/E	51.6x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



HOOD — Robinhood Markets, Inc. | August 17, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$108.00	\$98.00	\$85.00
6 Months	\$125.00	\$105.00	\$78.00
1 Year	\$150.00	\$110.00	\$70.00
2 Years	\$190.00	\$130.00	\$60.00
5 Years	\$275.00	\$175.00	\$50.00
10 Years	\$450.00	\$250.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.7% over 5 days) is ripping on Middle East tension and Trump's "drill baby drill" policy pipeline. Utilities also catching a bid as a defensive AI-power play (data centers need electricity).

COOLING OFF: Crypto-adjacent financials pulling back with Bitcoin — COIN, MSTR, CRCL all down alongside HOOD. Materials weak on China demand worries.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of speculative crypto/fintech and INTO hard assets (energy, utilities) as the market waits for Fed clarity and crypto regulation. That's a short-term headwind for HOOD.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the tokenization + prediction markets thesis but want less crypto beta, look at CME Group (CME) or ICE — they'd benefit from tokenized markets infrastructure without the Bitcoin whipsaw.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- SCHW (Charles Schwab): Boring broker winning on stable rate income and no crypto drag — safer version of the same trade.
- IBKR (Interactive Brokers): Better margins, growing internationally, less headline risk than HOOD.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is LAGGING traditional brokers this week because it got repriced as a crypto proxy — but it leads by a mile YTD. That tells you the market loves HOOD when crypto/policy tailwinds blow and dumps it fast when they reverse. It's the high-beta way to play retail finance.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$85-90 on crypto-driven pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: SEC tokenization framework killed, or crypto revenue drops >25% QoQ

Hedging: Small put spread or pair with COIN short if you own both

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Hold \$589.85 ▼ 0.86% 12M Price Target \$640.00 52-Week Range \$520.26 – \$790.80

Market Cap \$1.50T

META: Addiction Trial Kicks Off, Stock Stuck Mid-Range

WHAT HAPPENED

- The big one: the multi-state social media addiction trial starts TOMORROW (Tuesday). This is why the stock is soft — down 0.86% and sitting at just 26% of its 52-week range. States are alleging Facebook and Instagram deliberately hooked kids, and this trial has been building for years. Market is nervous but not panicking, which tells me a settlement or manageable outcome is already partly priced in.
- Simply Wall St. flagged Meta's "off-balance-sheet AI financing" — meaning Meta is funding massive AI infrastructure (data centers, chips) through structures that don't show up as debt on the books. It's a growing concern because it obscures how much they're actually spending on the AI arms race.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what's really going on: the stock is stuck because two overhangs are colliding. The addiction trial creates binary headline risk for weeks, and the off-balance-sheet AI spending story is making analysts question whether the ~\$70B+ in capex is being fully disclosed. Meanwhile, insiders (COO Olivan) are selling in a cluster and the put/call ratio at 0.33 looks bullish on the surface — but dig in, and there's unusual put buying at \$700 and \$730 strikes, which means someone with size is hedging against a summer rally fizzling out. Bottom line: this is a "wait for clarity" setup, not a "back up the truck" moment, even though the underlying ad business is firing on all cylinders.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

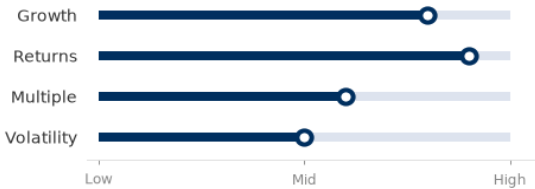
The real policy watch is KOSA (Kids Online Safety Act) — it's been ping-ponging through Congress and this trial will absolutely be used as ammunition by senators pushing to pass it. If KOSA passes, Meta faces a legal "duty of care" for minor users, which means more content moderation costs and potential product changes to Instagram. Separately, the FTC's antitrust case against Meta (trying to force Instagram/WhatsApp divestitures) is still grinding on — a Trump-appointed FTC has been surprisingly aggressive on Big Tech, so don't assume the political environment is friendly just because Republicans are in charge. Tailwind: proposed AI infrastructure tax credits in the reconciliation bill would directly subsidize Meta's data center buildout.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$589.85
12M Price Target	\$640.00
Upside / (Downside)	+8.5%
Market Cap	\$1.50T
FY2026E Revenue	\$202M
FY2027E Revenue	\$230M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	21.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$630.00	\$595.00	\$545.00
6 Months	\$720.00	\$640.00	\$520.00
1 Year	\$800.00	\$680.00	\$500.00
2 Years	\$950.00	\$780.00	\$480.00
5 Years	\$1400.00	\$1000.00	\$550.00
10 Years	\$2200.00	\$1500.00	\$600.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.67% in 5 days) is on fire — the Iran ceasefire expiring today is spiking oil risk premiums, and traders are positioning for supply disruption. Utilities also strong on AI power demand thesis.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (Meta's sector) is only up 1.59% over 5 days — lagging the market as regulatory fears and AI capex worries weigh on the mega-cap platforms.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of high-multiple tech and INTO energy/defensives as geopolitical risk rises with the Iran ceasefire expiration. That's a short-term headwind for Meta even though the fundamentals are fine.

RELATED PLAY: If you like Meta's AI thesis but want less legal risk, the picks-and-shovels plays are the winners — power/utility names supplying data centers (VST, CEG) and the chip supply chain. Groq's \$3.5B valuation this morning tells you private AI infrastructure money is still flowing hard.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GOOGL (Alphabet): Winning on cleaner AI narrative and less regulatory headline risk than Meta right now — Gemini traction is finally showing up in cloud numbers.
- NFLX (Netflix): No addiction lawsuits, no metaverse losses, pure ad-tier growth story — the "boring" Big Tech name outperforming on lack of drama.

META CONTEXT: Meta is LAGGING its Big Tech peers right now, and it's almost entirely legal/regulatory overhang, not fundamentals. That's actually setting up a decent contrarian opportunity IF the trial resolves reasonably — the fundamental gap will close quickly.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the business a lot, but I don't chase into a trial that starts tomorrow. Wait for the dip.

POSITION SIZE: 3-4% of portfolio — this is a core Big Tech holding, not a swing trade. Don't oversize into legal uncertainty.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add aggressively in the \$550-570 zone if the trial creates headline panic. Full position below \$540.

TIME HORIZON: 12-18 months — the catalyst you're waiting for is trial resolution + Q3/Q4 earnings proving ad growth is durable.

WHEN TO BAIL: Punitive damages verdict, ad revenue growth dropping below 10%, or if we learn the off-balance-sheet AI obligations are materially larger than disclosed.

HEDGING: Buy some cheap out-of-the-money puts covering the next 60 days through the trial — think of it as insurance premium on your position. Or pair with a Google long — if regulators go after all Big Tech, at least you're market-neutral on the sector risk.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$971.66 ▲ 2.30%	12M Price Target \$1150.00	52-Week Range \$113.46 – \$1255.00	Market Cap \$1.10T
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MU: Memory Melt-Up Continues as AI Demand Meets Policy Tailwinds

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU just crossed \$1,000 intraday — that's a psychological milestone, and the fact that it's happening while the broader Nasdaq is only slightly up tells you this is a memory-specific bid, not a "rising tide" rally. Sandisk moving with it confirms it: money is flowing into memory chip names specifically, likely front-running strong pricing data from the DRAM/NAND spot markets.
- The 60-day US-Iran ceasefire expiring is creating some risk-off noise in futures, but MU is shrugging it off — when a stock ignores macro fear, that's a tell that the underlying story is stronger than the market.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

See key data table.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- Memory is cyclical — the second HBM supply catches up to demand (probably late 2027), pricing rolls over and this stock can drop 40% fast. That's the "when to bail" scenario.
- Samsung is aggressive on HBM4 — if they leapfrog MU on the next generation, NVIDIA could shift orders and MU loses its premium positioning.
- The risk nobody's talking about: Taiwan escalation. MU's advanced packaging is heavily dependent on TSMC's CoWoS capacity in Taiwan. Any China-Taiwan flare-up and the whole supply chain seizes.

IN THE NEWS

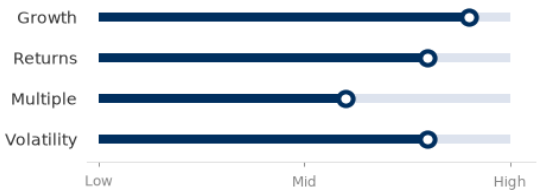
- Micron stock heats up again, crossing \$1,000** Yahoo Finance · 2026-08-17 11:53
- Update: US Equity Futures Mixed Pre-Bell as 60-Day US-Iran Ceasefire Expires** MT Newswires · 2026-08-17 12:55
- Stock Market Today: Dow Falls, Nasdaq Rises As Memory Chip Stocks Micron, Sandisk Extend G...** Investor's Business Daily · 2026-08-17 12:46
- Stocks to Watch: Alibaba, L3Harris, Diana Shipping, BHP** The Wall Street Journal · 2026-08-17 12:22
- Why Sandisk Stock Is Getting Its Mojo Back** Barrons.com · 2026-08-17 12:19

WHAT OPTIONS TRADERS ARE DOING

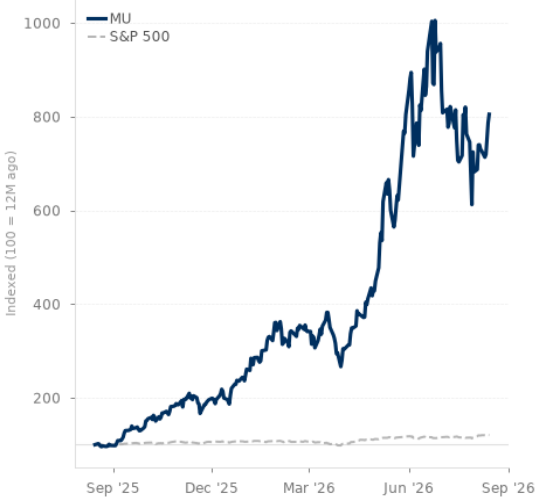
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$971.66
12M Price Target	\$1150.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.4%
Market Cap	\$1.10T
FY2026E Revenue	\$48,500M
FY2027E Revenue	\$62,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.50
FY2027E EPS	\$22.00
Fwd P/E	67.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1100.00	\$1010.00	\$880.00
6 Months	\$1300.00	\$1150.00	\$850.00
1 Year	\$1500.00	\$1200.00	\$800.00
2 Years	\$1800.00	\$1400.00	\$700.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1800.00	\$600.00
10 Years	\$4000.00	\$2500.00	\$500.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.67% over 5 days) is on fire — that's the Iran ceasefire expiration plus supply concerns. Memory/semis are the other hot pocket, driven by AI capex.

COOLING OFF: Software is losing steam (Oracle down today) — the "AI trade" is rotating from software to hardware/infrastructure, which is exactly where MU sits.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving from software AI plays (which already ran) into the picks-and-shovels layer — memory, networking, power. That rotation directly benefits MU.

RELATED PLAY: If you like MU, look at the memory equipment makers (LRCX, AMAT) — they sell the tools MU uses to build HBM, and they benefit whether MU or Samsung wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- **SNDK (Sandisk):** Riding the same NAND memory pricing wave — Barron's just flagged the "mojo" returning, meaning the whole memory complex is being re-rated.
- **AVGO (Broadcom):** Custom AI silicon demand keeps compounding — they're the other picks-and-shovels winner alongside MU.

MU CONTEXT: MU is leading the memory group, not lagging — that's important because in cyclical sectors, the leader keeps leading until the cycle turns. As long as MU is out-performing SNDK and the semis ETF, the trend is your friend.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — I'm pounding the table on the story but respectful of the fact that we're up huge already and cyclical stocks punish latecomers.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — the upside is real but memory stocks can draw down 40-50% when the cycle turns, so size matters.

ENTRY POINTS: Don't chase \$1,000. Wait for a pullback to \$880-920 (roughly the 20-day moving average) on any macro-fear day. If it never pulls back, scale in one-third now, two-thirds on weakness.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is HBM4 qualification with NVIDIA (expected 1H 2027) and CHIPS Act fab ramps.

WHEN TO BAIL: If DRAM spot prices roll over >15% month-over-month, or if MU loses HBM4 share to Samsung with NVIDIA — either is a thesis-breaker.

HEDGING: Buy some out-of-the-money puts 3-6 months out as insurance — think of it as paying a small premium to sleep at night when a cyclical stock is near all-time highs. Alternatively, pair with a short position in an over-earning semi name.

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$342.27 ▲ 0.68%	12M Price Target \$380.00	52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.35T
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TSLA: Grinding Higher on SpaceX Halo and EV Bottom Hopes

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA is up modestly again (+0.68%) and has quietly rallied ~3.5% off last week's lows on two things: Bernstein calling a bottom in the US EV market, and a Barron's piece pointing out that TSLA increasingly trades as a proxy for privately-held SpaceX (Musk halo effect). That matters because it means the stock is being repriced as an AI/space/robotics conglomerate, not a car company — which is exactly the narrative bulls need.
- Cathie Wood's ARK reportedly bought ~450K shares in 45 days, and options flow is screaming bullish — put/call ratio of 0.51 (meaning almost 2x as many bullish call bets as bearish put bets) with massive unusual call buying at the \$340-342.50 strikes. Someone with real money is betting on a near-term pop.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what this really means: the stock sits at just 22% of its 52-week range (\$297-\$499), so we're closer to the lows than the highs — that's why the tape feels heavy even on up days. The bullish setup is that if EV demand really has bottomed (Bernstein's call), Q3 delivery numbers in early October become a huge upside catalyst because expectations are on the floor. But here's the uncomfortable truth: the Trump administration's One Big Beautiful Bill killed the \$7,500 federal EV tax credit as of September 30, 2025, and we're now nearly a year into that headwind — so any "bottoming" story has to survive without government subsidy support. The bull case is now almost entirely dependent on Robotaxi scaling (Austin/Bay Area expansions) and Optimus, not car sales.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang: the EV tax credit is gone, CAFE fuel economy penalties were zeroed out (hurts Tesla's regulatory credit revenue, which was ~\$2B/year of pure profit), and California's EV mandate waiver was revoked. That's a triple headwind that Wall Street is still digesting. On the flip side, the administration's push on AI deregulation and autonomous vehicle federal preemption (overriding state-by-state robotaxi rules) is a MASSIVE tailwind for TSLA's Robotaxi rollout — watch for any NHTSA framework announcement, which could unlock nationwide deployment and add real value overnight.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

TSLA trades around 159x forward earnings — meaning investors are paying \$159 for every \$1 of expected profit next year, versus ~8x for Ford and GM. That's not a car valuation; it's a bet that Optimus and Robotaxi become real businesses. The valuation is only defensible if you believe the AI/robotics story — if this ends up being "just" a car company in 2027, the stock is worth closer to \$150, not \$340.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

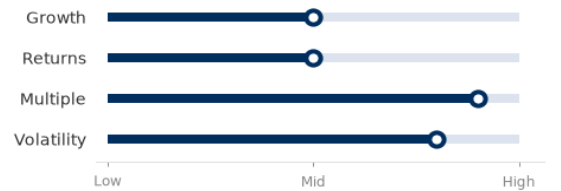
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-17 13:20 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$342.27
12M Price Target	\$380.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.0%
Market Cap	\$1.35T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$132M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.10
Fwd P/E	159.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$375.00	\$350.00	\$315.00
6 Months	\$430.00	\$370.00	\$290.00
1 Year	\$500.00	\$380.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$620.00	\$420.00	\$230.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$500.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$1500.00	\$700.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.67% over 5 days) is on fire — oil prices firming plus data center power demand story. Utilities also up on the AI-power thesis (data centers need electricity).

COOLING OFF: Materials is negative on the week; traditional cyclical are being ignored as capital concentrates in AI/energy.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing into the "AI physical infrastructure" trade — power, cooling, chips — which is a second-derivative bet on the same trends driving TSLA's Optimus/Robotaxi thesis. TSLA benefits indirectly because it validates the "AI is real" narrative that supports its multiple.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the TSLA autonomy story but hate the valuation, look at Mobileye (MBLY) or the LiDAR names — cheaper ways to play autonomous driving. If you like the Musk halo, watch anything with SpaceX exposure like Alphabet (GOOGL) and Nvidia (NVDA), which just got named as top SpaceX shareholders in today's news.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the king of the AI trade, and now a disclosed SpaceX shareholder — reinforces the Musk-ecosystem premium.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Also a top SpaceX holder; benefits from the same AI infrastructure buildout narrative.

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is LAGGING the Mag 7 badly this year — at 22% of its 52-week range while NVDA and GOOGL trade near highs. That tells us either (a) TSLA is the cheap catch-up trade if AI keeps ripping, or (b) the market has real concerns about auto fundamentals that aren't going away. Cathie Wood is betting on (a). I'd wait for Q3 deliveries before making that call.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$310-325 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Robotaxi rollout delays past 2027 or auto gross margin dips below 15%

Hedging: Buy protective puts 10% out of the money, or pair with a short position in a pure-play legacy automaker

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$225.16 ▼ 0.06%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.45T
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NVDA: OpenAI Deal Restructure Cools Concentration Fears

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA "rowed back" on its \$250B OpenAI pledge — sounds bad but the stock is UP on the news. Translation: the market was actually worried about how much cash NVDA was committing to a single customer (concentration risk = putting too many eggs in one basket). Scaling that back is a de-risking event.
- Meanwhile they're putting \$1.5B into SB Energy for the OpenAI data center power supply — this is the story nobody's talking about: AI is now an ENERGY story as much as a chip story (see Energy ETF +7.67% over 5 days — that's not a coincidence).

WHY IT MATTERS

The OpenAI pledge walkback tells you NVDA management is being disciplined about circular financing (where you invest in your customer so they can buy your product — Wall Street was starting to raise eyebrows). That's a bullish governance signal. The bigger inference: the SB Energy investment confirms that POWER, not chips, is now the bottleneck for AI growth — which is why utilities and energy ETFs are ripping. If you're bullish NVDA, you almost have to be bullish nuclear and grid infrastructure too, because their customers literally can't turn on the GPUs without more electricity. Watch this — Congress is quietly moving on permitting reform that would unlock data center power buildouts, and that's arguably more important to NVDA's next leg up than any chip announcement.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two policy levers to watch right now: (1) China export controls — the administration has been oscillating between allowing H2O chip sales to China (revenue tailwind) and tightening restrictions (headwind). Any hardening of the stance takes an estimated \$15-20B off the revenue line. (2) The AI infrastructure permitting reform push — bipartisan momentum to fast-track data center approvals and grid connections. If that passes, it accelerates NVDA's customer buildout cycle by 12-18 months. Also watch the CHIPS Act 2.0 chatter — extending domestic manufacturing subsidies helps NVDA's TSMC-Arizona supply chain.

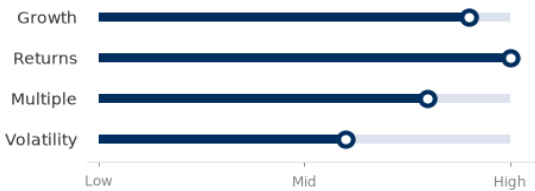
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$5.45T market cap and roughly 38x forward earnings, you're paying \$38 for every \$1 of profit NVDA is expected to make next year — expensive on the surface, but earnings are growing 40%+ so the PEG ratio (price relative to growth) is actually reasonable around 1x. Compared to other mega-cap tech at 28-32x with slower growth, NVDA is arguably fairly priced, not stretched. The risk isn't the multiple — it's whether AI capex from hyperscalers holds up; if Meta/Google/Microsoft trim spending, the whole story reprices fast.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$225.16
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.5%
Market Cap	\$5.45T
FY2027E Revenue	\$245M
FY2028E Revenue	\$310M
FY2027E EPS	\$5.85
FY2028E EPS	\$7.40
Fwd P/E	38.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$230.00	\$210.00
6 Months	\$265.00	\$245.00	\$200.00
1 Year	\$300.00	\$260.00	\$190.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$310.00	\$180.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$400.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$250.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.67% 5D) and Utilities — this is the AI power trade. Data centers need gigawatts and the market finally figured it out.

COOLING OFF: Materials slightly weak; no major sector in freefall — this is a broad risk-on tape.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO the "AI enablers" beyond just chips — power, cooling, grid, and nuclear. That's a tell that investors think the AI cycle has years left, not months.

RELATED PLAY: If you own NVDA, look at Vistra, Constellation Energy, or a nuclear-heavy utility ETF — they're the power picks-and-shovels play behind the picks-and-shovels play.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MU (Micron): Just crossed \$1,000 — high-bandwidth memory is sold out through 2027, they're a direct beneficiary of every NVDA GPU shipped.
- Energy names broadly: Riding the AI power thesis with real earnings behind it now.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is consolidating near highs while MU is ripping — that's actually healthy. It means the AI trade is broadening (money spreading to other names) rather than everyone crowded into NVDA. Historically when the ecosystem outperforms the leader, the leader catches up on the next earnings beat.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Pounding the table would be a 9, but at 84% of 52-week range I want a better entry. The fundamentals and policy setup are as good as they've been in months.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% of portfolio. Big enough to matter, small enough that a 20% drawdown doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on any pullback to \$215 or below. Options flow shows big call buying at \$225 strike — smart money expects upside but there's also a \$225 put wall, meaning that level is a battleground.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Catalysts: next earnings, China policy clarity, and any AI permitting bill movement in Congress this fall.

WHEN TO BAIL: If a hyperscaler cuts capex guidance by more than 10%, or if China export controls tighten materially, or if the stock breaks \$195 on volume.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a put option that pays off if the stock drops below \$200 (think of it as insurance costing 1-2% of your position). Or just keep some cash on the sidelines to add on dips.

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$345.90 ▼ 0.13%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$196.60 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.23T
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GOOGL: Gemini Hits 1B Users, Antitrust Still Looms

WHAT HAPPENED

- Gemini just crossed 1 billion active users — that's a massive milestone because 6 months ago people were writing Google's AI obituary. The stock isn't reacting today (-0.13%) which tells me the market hasn't fully repriced this yet. Wall Street is still anchored on "ChatGPT won" narrative from 2024.
- Unusual put buying at \$390-400 strikes expiring this month — someone's betting the stock DOESN'T break out above \$390 in the next two weeks. Could be hedging, could be conviction. Given we're at \$345, that's essentially a bet the rally pauses here.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the thing nobody's connecting: Gemini at 1B users while Search still prints ~\$200B/year means Google is doing what Meta did in 2022-2023 — using a monopoly cash cow to fund the AI war while competitors burn VC money. The put flow suggests short-term traders think the easy money's been made (stock is up 76% off the 52-week low), but the fundamental story is actually accelerating. Watch for this: if Google monetizes Gemini even at 1/10th the rate they monetize Search users, that's ~\$20B in incremental revenue nobody's modeling yet. The Reddit data licensing story is a sneaky tell — Google is paying for training data while also being Reddit's biggest customer, meaning they're playing both sides of the AI data economy.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The DOJ antitrust remedy phase is the elephant in the room — a ruling on potential Chrome divestiture or default search payment bans could land any week now, and that's the single biggest overhang on the stock. On the positive side, the Trump administration's AI executive orders have been notably permissive on model development (favoring US champions over EU-style regulation), which structurally helps Alphabet vs. Chinese competitors. Also watch the expiring US-Iran 60-day ceasefire mentioned in this morning's headlines — energy spike would hurt ad spending, which is 75% of Google's revenue.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$345, GOOGL trades around 35x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$35 for every \$1 of profit expected next year. That's a premium to the S&P but a DISCOUNT to Microsoft (~38x) and Meta (~28x adjusted for their AI capex burn). Given Gemini is now a legitimate consumer product AND Google Cloud is growing 30%+, this multiple looks reasonable — the market is still pricing in some antitrust discount that may reverse if the DOJ remedy comes in lighter than feared.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

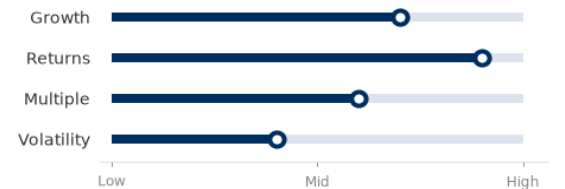
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-17 13:20 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$345.90
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.3%
Market Cap	\$4.23T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$478M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	35.1x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$365.00	\$350.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$375.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$430.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$500.00	\$425.00	\$280.00
5 Years	\$700.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1100.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.67% 5D) is running hard on the Iran ceasefire expiration — geopolitical risk premium is back. Utilities also strong as AI data center power demand narrative keeps compounding.

COOLING OFF: Materials weak (-0.61% 5D) suggesting no reflation trade. Tech/Comm Services only +1.59% — money isn't aggressively chasing mega-cap tech right now.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO energy and defensives, OUT of high-beta growth. That's a caution flag short-term for GOOGL but not a thesis-breaker — this looks like macro hedging, not a fundamental shift.

RELATED PLAY: If AI compute demand keeps compounding, the picks-and-shovels plays win too — think VRT (Vertiv), power infrastructure names, and data center REITs like DLR and EQIX.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- META (Meta Platforms): Ad duopoly partner also benefiting from AI ad targeting improvements, cheaper multiple
- MSFT (Microsoft): Enterprise AI monetization is further along via Copilot — the model for what Google needs to prove

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL has actually been LEADING mega-cap tech YTD after being the laggard in 2024. That tells me the "Google is losing AI" narrative is broken but not everyone's caught up yet — which is where the opportunity is.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — The Gemini 1B user milestone is a genuine narrative shift and the antitrust discount creates asymmetric upside if the ruling disappoints bears.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a bad DOJ ruling doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$335-345 (where we are now is fine). If it dips to \$325 on macro fear, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — waiting for DOJ remedy resolution and 2-3 quarters of Gemini monetization data.

WHEN TO BAIL: Forced Chrome/Android divestiture, Gemini user growth stalls under 1.2B, or Cloud growth drops below 20%.

HEDGING: Buy some September \$340 puts as cheap insurance against a bad antitrust headline — costs maybe 2% but caps your downside if the DOJ drops a bomb.

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy	\$222.02 ▼ 0.07%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$61.44 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$199.27B
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MRVL: Custom Silicon King Riding AI Capex Wave

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL ran ~6.5% last week (\$208 → \$222) and is holding those gains — the trigger was that Aug 14 semi-wide rally where Marvell, Micron, and Western Digital all popped together. Translation: money is flowing back into AI infrastructure names, not just Nvidia.
- The 24/7 Wall St piece this morning framing Broadcom vs. Marvell as "kings of custom silicon" matters more than it sounds — every time analysts publicly debate that duopoly, it reinforces Marvell as the #2 must-own name in custom AI chips (called ASICs — chips designed for one specific customer like Amazon or Microsoft, versus Nvidia's off-the-shelf GPUs).

WHY IT MATTERS

The setup here is that Marvell is transitioning from "networking chip company" to "AI custom silicon powerhouse," and the market is slowly repricing it accordingly — you can see it in the stock being at 60% of its 52-week range with room to run back toward \$330. The bigger inference: when hyperscalers (Amazon, Microsoft, Google) design their own AI chips to reduce Nvidia dependence, they hire Marvell or Broadcom to actually build them — so every dollar of AI capex that goes to "custom" instead of "merchant" GPUs flows disproportionately to these two names. The options flow is interesting though — put/call ratio of 0.55 looks bullish on the surface (more calls than puts), but that unusual \$275 put buy for September tells me someone big is hedging near-term downside into earnings season. Read: institutions are long-term believers but bracing for a potential guidance wobble.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

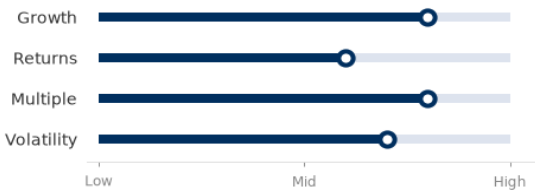
The two policy levers that matter most right now: (1) CHIPS Act Phase 2 funding disbursements — Marvell benefits indirectly because its foundry partner TSMC's Arizona fabs are getting subsidized, lowering Marvell's long-term production costs, and (2) the ongoing tightening of US export controls to China on advanced semis, which is a double-edged sword — it protects Marvell's US hyperscaler moat but caps their China revenue (roughly 40% of sales historically, though shrinking). Watch the Commerce Department's next round of entity list updates in September; if they add more Chinese AI companies, expect a short-term dip but a long-term positive as Western hyperscalers accelerate their custom-silicon roadmaps. The AI Diffusion Rule framework is also worth tracking — any loosening for allied nations (UAE, Saudi) opens new customer markets for Marvell's AI networking chips.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$222.02
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.1%
Market Cap	\$199.27B
FY2027E Revenue	\$8,900M
FY2028E Revenue	\$11,200M
FY2027E EPS	\$2.85
FY2028E EPS	\$4.10
Fwd P/E	77.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



MRVL — Marvell Technology, Inc. | August 17, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$245.00	\$228.00	\$205.00
6 Months	\$285.00	\$250.00	\$190.00
1 Year	\$330.00	\$260.00	\$175.00
2 Years	\$420.00	\$310.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$400.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.7% over 5 days) — power demand from AI data centers is finally showing up in the tape, which is actually bullish for MRVL because it confirms the AI buildout is real, not hype. Utilities also creeping up for the same reason.

COOLING OFF: Materials slightly negative on 5-day — reflects softer China industrial demand, which is a mild headwind for the broader semi supply chain.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from pure-play AI software into AI infrastructure (chips, power, cooling) — that's a direct tailwind for MRVL as investors position for the "second wave" of AI winners.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the MRVL thesis, look at Vertiv (VRT) for data center cooling and Constellation Energy (CEG) for the power side — same AI capex tailwind, less crowded trade.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): The other "custom silicon king" — winning because Google TPU volumes are ramping and they have more diversified AI exposure.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the reference point — cash flow being redeployed into AI startups (per the Aug 15 Barchart piece), which creates a broader AI ecosystem tailwind.

MRVL CONTEXT: Marvell is lagging AVGO year-to-date but leading over the past week — that's a "catch-up trade" setup where investors are rotating into the cheaper custom silicon name. If AVGO reports strong AI numbers first, MRVL typically rallies in sympathy 3-5 days later.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$205-215 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Loss of Amazon Trainium or Microsoft Maia custom silicon socket, or AI capex slowdown

Hedging: Pair with short AVGO or long SMH ETF to isolate Marvell-specific alpha

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$143.83 · 1M: +32.9% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$18.1B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
2	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$39.84 · 1M: +48.2% · P/S: 0.7x · Cap: \$25.8B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$52 entry				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
3	MDB	MongoDB, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$460.33 · 1M: +38.2% · P/S: 14.2x · Cap: \$37.0B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
4	KTOS	Kratos Defense & Security Solutions Defense Technology	8.6/10	BUY
Price: \$64.58 · 1M: +30.0% · P/S: 8.0x · Cap: \$12.1B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
5	PATH	UiPath, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.6/10	WATCH
Price: \$16.01 · 1M: +34.0% · P/S: 5.0x · Cap: \$8.3B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$14 entry				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				